

1947, February 24

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX CAPUCHIN FRIARY

HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

February 24th 1947.

Mrs. Raymond Gabriella Smith  
8756 Knodell  
Detroit, Michigan.

Dear Mrs. Smith:

God bless you and yours. Many thanks for your favor of the 20th, just noted.

I am certainly pleased to know that things are brightening up in some ways at least. Just keep up your courage and pray on, and you may be absolutely sure that God will never fail to be more than liberally generous. In fact we only have to think of how merciful He has patience with poor sinners who never seem to think of Him - ourselves included - to be convinced that it is out of the question for Him to fail in His goodness to those who call on Him with confidence, sorry for our poor sins.

I am glad you are able by the grace of God to have patience with those who laugh or sneer at anyone turning back to serve God and save their souls. Just that is the very secret of success in the science of saving our souls, after all the greatest science of all times and of all generations: RELIGION, THE SCIENCE OF OUR HAPPY RELATIONSHIP AND DEPENDENCE ON GOD AND OUR NEIGHBOR.

Some people have a queer notion of religion and, therefore, I might say an even queerer idea of conversion. .... It seems to me, therefore, that to be converted means to receive the grace of God, one way or other, to come back more and more earnestly and more practically to know, to love and to serve God. And since we are all so inclined to go wrong and to sin - even born in sin -- we can always be converted (in the wider sense), from our less perfect ways: and if outside the true Church, people can be converted from paganism and Judaism to Christianity. If they already believe in Jesus Christ as so many good protestants do, they can be converted from their errors and from human, therefore erroneous systems of religion, to the one and only divinely established founded system, viz, the Catholic system or true Church of Jesus Christ.